HSR Editorial Board

RE: Submission of Original Research Article

"Bladder Cancer in the United States: National Trends and State-Level Patterns from Global Burden of Disease (GBD) Study, 1980–2021"

Dear Editors,

We are pleased to submit our manuscript, "**Bladder Cancer in the United States: National Trends and State-Level Patterns from Global Burden of Disease (GBD) Study, 1980–2021**," for consideration as an Original Research Article in **HSR**.

This study provides a **reproducible descriptive epidemiologic analysis** of bladder cancer burden across the United States using GBD 2021 estimates. We examined national and state-level trends in incidence, prevalence, mortality, years lived with disability, years of life lost, and disability-adjusted life years from 1980 to 2021, with additional analyses by age and sex. We also **benchmarked U.S. trends against comparator health systems**, including the European Union, high-SDI countries, and high-income settings.

Although U.S. cancer registries provide measured incidence and mortality data, GBD offers standardized estimates across several burden measures, including DALYs, YLLs, and YLDs. Our aim is therefore not to replace registry-based surveillance, but to complement it by describing the broader burden of bladder cancer across states using a unified framework.

The manuscript's main strengths are its national and state-level scope, use of multiple burden metrics beyond incidence and mortality, and fully **reproducible workflow**. All data are **publicly available** through the Global Health Data Exchange, and the analytic code, cleaned datasets, and supplementary visualizations are available through our GitHub repository.

This work has not been published and is not under consideration elsewhere. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission to HSR. The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Thank you for considering our manuscript.

Sincerely,

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